

Romarjo Balukja

Senior Software Engineer · Full-Stack & DevOps

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software engineer with 7+ years of experience building and operating complex, production web applications end to end. Full-stack across Python/Django and React/Next.js/TypeScript, with deep ownership of the deployment lifecycle: GitLab CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes and ArgoCD-based GitOps. Specialised in multi-tenant SaaS architecture, SSO/identity (Keycloak, Better Auth, OAuth/OIDC) and data-intensive backends built on pandas pipelines. Enjoys diving deep into the hardest parts of a system, refactoring toward clean separation of concerns, and shipping incrementally with the team. Effective, async-friendly remote collaborator.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, C#, PHP, SQL

Frontend: React.js, Next.js, Redux, React Query, Hooks, TailwindCSS, MaterialUI, shadcn/ui, Styled Components, Gatsby, Storybook

Backend: Django, Django REST Framework, Flask, Node.js, .NET Core, Entity Framework, TypeORM

Data & Databases: Pandas (vectorised pipelines), PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server, SQLite

DevOps & Cloud: Docker, Kubernetes, Kustomize, ArgoCD (GitOps), GitLab CI/CD, AWS (EC2, RDS, Lambda, S3, CloudFront, CloudWatch), Azure DevOps, Renovate

Auth & Identity: Keycloak (multi-tenant SSO), Better Auth, Auth0, OAuth 2.0 / OIDC, stateless JWT sessions

Testing: Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress (e2e), PyTest, Enzyme

Architecture: Multi-tenant SaaS, Progressive Web Apps & service workers, structured logging (Pino), JSON Schema validation, REST API design

Tooling & VCS: Git, GitHub, GitLab, TFS, Postman, Figma, WebStorm, PyCharm, DataGrip

Ways of working: Agile, Scrum, code review, incremental & consensus-driven change

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer — Full-Stack & Platform

Jan 2023 – Present

Public-transport / mobility e-ticketing company (name withheld)

- Built and maintained a multi-tenant Next.js / TypeScript webshop for public-transport e-ticketing serving multiple transit operators from a single codebase.
- Implemented multi-tenant SSO with Keycloak; migrated the webshop authentication from react-oidc-context to Better Auth with stateless JWT sessions and per-tenant OAuth/OIDC providers, and resolved a session-persistence bug caused by oversized chunked cookies.
- Built a Progressive Web App ticket viewer with a three-tier caching strategy (in-memory, SessionStorage, IndexedDB), service worker, automatic template-version migration and postMessage integration with third-party host apps.
- Containerised services and deployed to Kubernetes using Kustomize; maintained GitLab CI/CD with per-tenant build configurations and credential masking.
- Introduced structured logging with Pino in Next.js to improve observability across tenants.

Stack: Next.js, React, TypeScript, Keycloak, Better Auth, Kubernetes, Kustomize, GitLab CI/CD, Pino, PWA / Service Workers

Software Development Engineer

Oct 2018 – 2023

Freelance / Long-term client engagements

Bakery & Food-Retail Order Management Platform — Long-running engagement on a multi-tenant SaaS that calculates food waste and optimises in-store production and ordering for bakery and food-retail chains.

- Architected and built multi-tenant features end to end across a Django/Python backend and a React/TypeScript frontend.

- Designed and refactored data-intensive backend logic on pandas pipelines — distribution calculations, hierarchical article/tour aggregation, and a configurable business-rule engine — replacing iterrows-heavy code with vectorised operations for major performance gains.
- Owned the delivery pipeline: GitLab CI/CD with tag-based releases and Renovate; containerised with Docker and deployed via ArgoCD (GitOps).
- Added JSON Schema validation for preview-request APIs, React Query caching hooks and Cypress e2e coverage for lazy-loaded order-tuning UIs.

Stack: Django, Django REST, Flask, Pandas, PostgreSQL, React, TypeScript, GitLab CI/CD, Docker, ArgoCD, Cypress, PyTest

Moneyfarm (Fintech - Team Extension) — Worked embedded with the Moneyfarm team on several of their fintech products.

- Built front-end and back-end features including a public-facing pension calculator, with full unit and e2e test coverage.
- Implemented third-party client access via Auth0 and developed UI pages with Gatsby.

Stack: Django, React, Redux, TailwindCSS, Next.js, Auth0, Gatsby, Jest with Enzyme, Cypress, Storybook

Geolocation Platform — Embeddable iframe platform integrated into an existing app to render JPEG2000 imagery and map points to locations.

- Designed the project architecture, built front-end functionality and integrated web services at the API level, with CI/CD integration and unit testing.

Stack: React.js, Django, Unit Tests, CI/CD

Software Development Engineer

Sep 2020 – Apr 2022

Division5

Content Management System (Cooking Company) — Full-stack CMS to manage recipe data, products and users; responsible for both front-end and back-end design.

- Designed and developed the project architecture and implemented features across the stack.
- Created and integrated REST APIs and implemented & maintained the AWS infrastructure (EC2, RDS, Lambda, S3, CloudFront, CloudWatch).

Theatre App — Web app for customers to manage tickets, validations and events.

- Built front-end and back-end functionality, integrated API services, and led part of the team through reviews.

Stack: Node.js, TypeORM, TypeScript, AWS, React, Redux, MaterialUI

Software Development Engineer

Nov 2019 – Apr 2020

BinaryTree, Inc.

Power365 / PowerAD (Microsoft / Active Directory) — Worked on Microsoft Power apps involving Active Directory migration and management.

- Developed features including full database text search, plus front-end, back-end and API-level integrations.

Stack: .NET Core, TypeORM, Dapper, Threading & Concurrency, LINQ, FluentAPI, prepared statements, Azure DevOps, TFS

Software Development Engineer

Apr 2019 – Apr 2020

Kreatx

Check-in / Check-out System — Built a .NET system computing employee in/out times, with a CMS-triggered monthly calculation process.

- Developed front-end, back-end and API integrations using SQLite as the data store.

HR & Finance CMS — Software to help companies manage finances and employee data.

- Built and maintained full-stack functionality and integrated services at the API level.

Stack: .NET Framework, SQLite, MySQL, jQuery, PHP

EDUCATION

MSc, Banking Management

2025 – Present

“Aleksandër Moisiu” University, Durrës

BSc, Computer Engineering

2018

Epoka University